ALLY WEALTH • AUTHOR VISIBILITY CONSULTANT

Goodreads Marketing Guide for Authors

A reader-first approach to author presence, book information and community participation.

A practical workbook and reference guide

EDUCATIONAL RESOURCE • 2026 EDITION

How to use this guide

Goodreads is a reader-oriented platform whose features, rules and availability can change. This guide focuses on clear book information, authentic participation and ethical reader engagement. Verify current Goodreads help pages and promotional policies before using any feature or campaign tactic.

Work through the pages in order. Use the prompts to make decisions, record assumptions and identify actions. You can revisit a page when your book, audience or publishing plan changes.

Keep the work evidence-aware. Platform interfaces, policies and marketplace features change. Verify current official guidance before acting on platform-specific instructions. Treat examples as planning aids, not guarantees.

Make it your own. Not every tactic belongs in every campaign. Choose the actions that fit your book, resources, readers and values.

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01 / FIELD GUIDE

Understand the reader context

Approach Goodreads as a place where readers catalogue, rate, review and discuss books. A useful author presence supports discovery and accurate information rather than treating every interaction as a sales pitch.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **understand the reader context**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

02 / FIELD GUIDE

Claim and maintain an author profile

Where the current process permits, verify the correct author identity and keep biography, photo, website and book information accurate. Follow the platform’s current author-program requirements.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **claim and maintain an author profile**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

03 / FIELD GUIDE

Check book records

Review title, author attribution, editions, publication details, series data and cover images. Incorrect or duplicate records can confuse readers and should be addressed through current platform procedures.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **check book records**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Keep editions understandable

Readers may encounter multiple formats and editions. Provide accurate identifiers and edition details where supported, and avoid creating duplicate records unnecessarily.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **keep editions understandable**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Write a reader-friendly author bio

Use a concise biography that helps readers understand your work and interests. Include relevant links where allowed and avoid exaggerated claims.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **write a reader-friendly author bio**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Connect books to a series

Ensure the reading order and series relationships are clear. Check how the platform currently handles series data and edition connections.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **connect books to a series**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Understand ratings and reviews

Ratings and reviews belong to readers. Do not pressure readers for a particular score, argue about opinions or coordinate artificial activity.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **understand ratings and reviews**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Invite honest feedback ethically

If you invite readers to review, make the request voluntary and neutral. Do not offer rewards for positive ratings or make a benefit conditional on a review.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **invite honest feedback ethically**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Participate in discussions

Join conversations that genuinely interest you. Answer questions when you can add value and respect group rules, moderator decisions and reader boundaries.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **participate in discussions**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Read group rules first

Groups have different purposes and moderation standards. Some prohibit self-promotion. Never assume that a promotional post is welcome because another group allows it.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **read group rules first**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Share updates selectively

Use platform-supported updates only where appropriate and permitted. Focus on useful context, new editions or relevant reader information rather than repetitive sales messages.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **share updates selectively**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Coordinate with your wider platform

Your Goodreads profile should align with your website, retailer pages and other author profiles. Check links and book facts regularly.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **coordinate with your wider platform**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Use giveaways only if available and appropriate

Giveaway features, eligibility, fees and rules may change by territory and time. Verify current terms, costs and fulfilment responsibilities before committing.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **use giveaways only if available and appropriate**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Plan a giveaway responsibly

If using a permitted giveaway, define the audience, budget, quantity, eligibility and delivery process. Do not imply that entrants must leave a review or positive rating.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **plan a giveaway responsibly**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Avoid review manipulation

Never buy ratings, use fake accounts, exchange reviews in ways that breach policy or ask close contacts to misrepresent their independence.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **avoid review manipulation**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Handle critical reviews calmly

Readers are entitled to their opinions. Do not identify or target reviewers, disclose private messages or try to mobilise followers against criticism.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **handle critical reviews calmly**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Use reader feedback as insight

Look for recurring confusion about genre, reading order or book details. A single review is one person’s experience, not a definitive assessment of the entire audience.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **use reader feedback as insight**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Support accurate book discovery

Use consistent titles, descriptions and series information. When readers ask where to begin, provide a clear reading-order answer.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **support accurate book discovery**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Prepare a Goodreads checklist

Check profile accuracy, book records, links, series data, community rules and privacy settings. Keep a dated note of completed updates.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **prepare a goodreads checklist**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Connect Goodreads with launch planning

If a release is approaching, ensure book details are accurate and that any communication complies with platform rules. Do not assume a platform feature will create a launch campaign by itself.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **connect goodreads with launch planning**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Build a respectful outreach message

If contacting a reader or group is allowed, be transparent about who you are and why you are writing. Keep it brief and make declining easy.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **build a respectful outreach message**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Protect reader privacy

Do not export, scrape or repurpose reader information without a lawful basis and appropriate permission. Respect platform privacy controls and applicable law.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **protect reader privacy**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Understand platform change

Features and procedures can be modified. Check current official help and announcements rather than relying on old screenshots or tutorials.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **understand platform change**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Measure useful signals

Track relevant profile visits, reader questions, book-page accuracy and permitted campaign outcomes where available. Avoid treating follower counts as the only measure.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **measure useful signals**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Troubleshoot book-page issues

Document the incorrect information, identify the current correction route and submit a clear request. Keep evidence and avoid creating duplicate entries as a workaround.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **troubleshoot book-page issues**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Use Goodreads alongside other channels

A reader platform is one part of a broader discovery system. Connect it with your website, newsletter, retailer pages and events without duplicating every message.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **use goodreads alongside other channels**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

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Working notes

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Create an author engagement rhythm

Choose a sustainable schedule for profile maintenance and genuine participation. Do not force daily activity if it does not serve readers or your writing life.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **create an author engagement rhythm**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

- Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?
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Working notes

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Prepare for reader questions

Have accurate answers about reading order, genre, content, formats and availability. If information is uncertain, verify before responding.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **prepare for reader questions**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Review the platform relationship

Ask whether the time spent is helping readers find accurate information or creating meaningful conversations. Adjust your level of activity accordingly.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **review the platform relationship**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Your Goodreads action plan

Record profile tasks, book data corrections, community spaces, ethical outreach boundaries and the next review date.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **your goodreads action plan**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes